

RYAN F LOPEZ-DUNN

Security Engineer | IAM & Identity Security | Endpoint Defense | Incident Response

lopezdunn90@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineer with hands-on enterprise experience across identity security, endpoint defense, detection engineering, incident response, and security risk review. Strong production experience with Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, phishing-resistant authentication, Microsoft Defender XDR, Intune, Cisco Umbrella, KQL hunting, Qualys, PCI support, and vendor risk reviews. Known for turning live investigations into repeatable workflows, improving controls with measurable impact, and communicating findings clearly to technical and non-technical teams.

CORE IT & CYBERSECURITY SKILLS

Identity & Access: Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, Authentication Strength, FIDO2/passkeys, Windows Hello for Business, PIM, SSPR, account lifecycle and privilege review

Detection & Hunting: KQL Advanced Hunting, custom detections, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, honeytokens, alert tuning, investigation documentation

Risk, Compliance & Vendors: HECVAT, SOC 2 interpretation, PCI/Qualys support, vulnerability findings, security exceptions, vendor risk documentation

Endpoint & XDR: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint/XDR, device isolation, Live Response, ASR rules, endpoint hardening, alert validation, malware containment

Cloud & Network Security: Cisco Umbrella, AD identity attribution, DNS-layer visibility, policy review, suspicious network activity analysis

User & IT Operations: Windows authentication troubleshooting, browser security settings, phishing triage, user communications, Teams remote support, ticket documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Engineer | Indiana State University, Office of Information Technology | Terre Haute, IN

Aug 2025 - Present

- Engineer and support security controls across identity, endpoint, data, device, and application layers using Microsoft Defender, Entra ID, Conditional Access, Intune, and related Microsoft security tooling.
- Investigate and contain security incidents involving phishing, malware, cryptomining activity, suspicious network behavior, and endpoint compromise indicators using Defender XDR, Advanced Hunting/KQL, endpoint isolation, and evidence-based timelines.
- Support phishing-resistant MFA and stronger authentication coverage with FIDO2/passkeys, Windows Hello for Business, Authentication Strength, and Conditional Access policy testing/troubleshooting.
- Created and tuned KQL-driven detections and repeatable investigation workflows mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, improving consistency across alert triage, escalation, and post-incident documentation.
- Implemented Active Directory identity attribution into Cisco Umbrella workflows, improving investigation context and helping reduce response time by approximately 50%.
- Support vulnerability management, PCI evidence, Qualys reporting, vendor security reviews, HECVAT/SOC 2 interpretation, and security exception analysis for university systems.

Information Technology Security Consultant | Indiana State University | Terre Haute, IN

Nov 2024 - Aug 2025

- Supported day-to-day security operations by triaging alerts, reviewing suspicious sign-ins, documenting incidents, and coordinating remediation steps with technical teams and end users.
- Assisted with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint configuration, endpoint hardening, alert investigation, device isolation decisions, and security baseline implementation.
- Helped assess identity and access risks involving MFA, Conditional Access, Windows authentication, privileged access, shared accounts, and account ownership gaps.
- Translated technical findings into clear ticket updates, recommendations, and risk explanations for stakeholders across security, infrastructure, help desk, and business teams.

SELECTED SECURITY PROJECTS

- Phishing-resistant MFA rollout: supported enterprise authentication improvements for 3,000+ users using FIDO2/passkeys, Windows Hello for Business, Authentication Strength, Conditional Access, and legacy authentication controls.
- Defender XDR investigation workflow: designed repeatable triage steps covering alert validation, affected device review, evidence collection, containment, escalation points, and post-incident improvement.
- Cryptomining response: hunted across DeviceProcessEvents and DeviceNetworkEvents, mapped activity to MITRE ATT&CK T1496, isolated endpoints, and created persistent detections to reduce recurrence.
- Honeytoken detection: designed dormant account monitoring and alert logic using SigninLogs/AlertInfo-style workflows to improve credential-theft and insider-threat visibility.
- Vendor and identity verification research: evaluated fraud and identity verification vendors, reviewed security/compliance implications, and documented implementation considerations for HR/student account workflows.
- PCI and vulnerability support: assisted with Qualys PCI reporting, scan issue analysis, evidence collection, and security recommendations for payment-related infrastructure.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

CompTIA Security+ - Current cybersecurity certification covering security operations, threats, architecture, risk, and incident response fundamentals.

CompTIA A+ - IT support and endpoint troubleshooting certification covering hardware, operating systems, networking, and operational procedures.

Professional Certificate - Cybersecurity & Information Assurance, Ivy Tech Community College - Cybersecurity and information assurance credential.

B.S. Cybercriminology - Indiana State University - In progress. Coursework focus includes cybercrime analysis, digital investigations, digital risk, and information security.

SC-300: Microsoft Identity and Access Administrator - In progress.

CYSA+ - In progress

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Microsoft Entra ID | Conditional Access | Authentication Strength | Microsoft Defender XDR | Defender for Endpoint | Defender for Office 365 | Intune | KQL | Microsoft Sentinel exposure | Cisco Umbrella | Qualys | Netwrix | Cloudflare | MITRE ATT&CK | HECVAT | SOC 2 | PCI support | TeamDynamix ticketing